



Pakistan's Foreign Policy

Defining Foreign Policy

- “The sum of State’s strategy to strengthen its national capacity, the approach to attain national goal and the tools to deal with the other elements of the world”.
- “Foreign policy encompasses the tactics and process by which a nation interacts with other nations in order to further its own interests. Foreign policy may make use of diplomacy or other more direct means such as aggression rooted in military power” (Brionne Frazier, 2019)
- **Foreign Policy making has two models:**
 1. Rational Actor Model
 2. Bureaucratic Model.

Levels of Foreign Policy Making

1. Individual Centric Level
2. State Level/inside out approach
3. International level/outside in approach
4. Regional approach.

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Guiding Principles Pakistan's Foreign Policy

- The foreign policy of Pakistan is primarily directed to the pursuit of national goals of seeking peace and stability through international cooperation. Special emphasis is laid on economic diplomacy to take advantages offered by the process of globalization as also to face challenges of the 21st century. Our foreign policy is also geared to project the image of the country as a dynamic and moderate society.
- The foreign policy of Pakistan seeks to promote the internationally recognized norms of interstate relations, i.e. respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity of all States, non-interference in the internal affairs of other State; non-aggression and peaceful settlement of disputes. Pakistan has therefore always sought to develop friendly and cordial relations with all countries of the world.

Objectives Of Pakistan's Foreign Policy

In light of the guiding principles laid down by the founding fathers and the constitution as also aspirations of the people of Pakistan, the objectives of foreign policy can be summarized as under:

1. Promotion of Pakistan as a dynamic, progressive, moderate, and democratic Islamic country.
2. Developing friendly relations with all countries of the world, especially major powers and immediate neighbors.
3. Safeguarding national security and geo-strategic interests, including Kashmir.
4. Consolidating our commercial and economic cooperation with international community.
5. Safeguarding the interests of Pakistani Diaspora abroad.
6. Ensuring optimal utilization of national resources for regional and international cooperation.

Historical Background of Pakistan Foreign Policy

- Since 1947 Pakistani policy makers have developed a strategic personality which developed into “Strategic Enclave”.
- This culture is dominated and supported mostly by military along bureaucrats in ministry of foreign affairs.
- These individuals are the keepers of Pakistan’s “Strategic culture”.
- Pakistan foreign policy which is mainly relying on the act of “Balancing”.
- Those who formulate foreign policy are a small group of bureaucrats called as “Steel Frame”.
- Pakistan foreign Policy during formulation was centered on two problems in the initial days:
 - i. Territorial defense of Pakistan.
 - ii. Economic development and Industrialization.
 - iii. Formation of security threat perception and dominance of military.

Historical Background of Pakistan Foreign Policy

- Pakistan is a nation of contending identities and these identities are operational at parallel and horizontal levels. On parallel level the contention is emerging from religious basis since its creation.
- The second flowing horizontally are ethnic/nationalist identity contentions.
- Pakistan was to be an extraordinary state, a homeland for Indian Muslims and an ideological and political leader of the Islamic world.
- **Religion as tool of Policy:** Pakistani decision makers have found religious extremists to be natural allies and to be used as tool of foreign policy due to:
 - a) Its own religious identity basis.
 - b) The perception of India as Hindu state which has not accepted Pakistan as independent state.
 - c) The United States which also considered Islamic forces as good allies against Soviet Union during Afghan war.
 - d) The centralist post colonist state dominated by military has always considered secular, nationalists and democratic forces as a challenge to its hold on power.

Pakistan relationship with different countries

1- Pakistan Relation with India:

- The main contention with India is division of India and Pakistan stand over Kashmir. Pakistan and fought 4 wars over Kashmir but still it remained a bone of contention between the two states. Both states military and arsenal race is due to India as Status-quo and Pakistan as revisionist power.
- Due to Kashmir issue Pakistan and India has developed severe rivalry over water distribution rights. Pakistan and India signed Indus water treaty in 1960 with the assurance of World Bank.

2- Pakistan Joining American Camp:

- Liaquat Ali Khan adopted Pro-western is the orientation is the corner stone of Pakistan foreign Policy.
- USA has included Pakistan in three major treaties Mutual Defense Assistance Agreement in May 1954, South-East Asia Treaty Organization (SEATO) September 1954, and Baghdad Pact or later Central Treaty Organization (CENTO) in September 1955.
- Pakistan helped China and USA during 1970's to enhance their bilateral relations.
- Pakistan became an ally of USA during Afghan war 1980's and later became partner in 2001 on war on terror.

Pakistan relationship with different countries

3- Pakistan relation with China:

- China and India went on war in 1962, and Pakistan found a friend in Asia.
- In Early days People's republic of China (PRC) was not recognized as Security Council member rather Taiwan was permanent member. Pakistan was first state to recognized China as State.
- Pakistan played a major role in reviving PRC relation with USA in 1971 talks between the two states.
- Currently Pak-China relation has reached a new heights of signing China Pakistan Economic Corridor deals and bringing mega development project into Pakistan.

4- Pakistan relation with Afghanistan:

- In 1944 Afghanistan renounced the Durand Line Treaty with British Government which has marked the boundary between the two states.
- Muhammad Daud Khan in 1961 broke diplomatic relations with Pakistan.
- During Afghan War Pakistan tried to level score with Afghanistan and declared it as strategic dept.

Pakistan relationship with different countries

5- Pakistan relations with Muslim World:

- Pakistan has always maintained good relation with Saudi Arabia due to Sunnism and religious places in Saudi Arabia.
- In 1974 Pakistan hold Lahore Summit of Muslim leaders. It was attended by major Muslim leaders.
- Pakistan developed good relation with Iran during Raza Shah Pehlevi rule of 1950's and 1960's.
- Pakistani Constitution guide policy makers to maintain good relations with Muslim world that is why Pakistan is having good relation with Turkey, Iran, Malaysia, Indonesia Saudi Arabia UAE and other Muslim countries of the world.